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Top Skills

Program Management
Quality Assurance
Customer Segmentation Strategy

Patrick Byrne

I help move tech downrange in months, not years.
Seattle, Washington, United States

Summary

My life changed when I was asked to become a Program Manager for Air Force One. As PM, I reminded every new employee, “You’re not just working on the President’s Aircraft, you’re building the iconic symbol of democracy and freedom abroad.” Today, that freedom is under threat. America’s adversaries are moving faster than ever, while the warfighters who protect us operate with outdated tools and technology that pales in comparison to the phone in your pocket.I’ve never worn a uniform, but I’ve made it my mission to move the best technology downrange and into the hands of those who keep us safe. Because one day, my kids might have to wear a uniform and today, someone’s kids already do. Over 20 years in Aerospace and Defense, I’ve led product, program, and GTM efforts across every layer of the defense innovation stack. I gravitate to Product because it demands the rare blend of strategic thinking, technical fluency, and tactical execution. From a seat at the table of Defense Primes to the ground floor of defense tech startups, I’ve managed more than 55 products and driven over $2.1 billion in revenue. I’ve deployed technology in some of the most complex, high-stakes environments on Earth.Now I help other leaders do the same.As a NATO DIANA Defense Expert and a DIU Defense Technology Acceleration Mentor, I’ve seen what it really takes to cross the Valley of Death. Great dual-use products (and great companies) are built when leaders set a clear vision, align teams toward that success, and empower them to bring their full talents and experience to the mission. But building great products isn’t enough. Winning in defense means navigating the Byzantine labyrinth of defense acquisition; a path that too often feels reserved for those with Pentagon pedigree or membership to the Beltway boys’ club. That’s where Warfighter Ready comes in.At Warfighter Ready, we give founders a proven playbook for turning prototypes into Programs of Record. We unlock operator access, enable field testing, find champions, and leverage acquisition vehicles to help our clients build, scale, and deliver capability for the warfighter. We’re building from the Pacific Northwest because it’s home to the richest untapped defense-tech ecosystem in the

country. With its deep tech talent, early-stage capital, and proximity to some of the Department's most critical military facilities, the PNW is poised to become the Silicon Valley of dual-use innovation - I'm here to make that happen.Let's get your tech where it belongs: downrange into the hands of the warfighter.

Experience

Warfighter Ready
Founder, President
June 2024 - Present (2 years 1 month)
Seattle, WA

Warfighter Ready helps dual-use companies move their tech downrange in months, not years. We accelerate testing, development and adoption of DefTech from prototypes to Program of Record. Our programs are designed to prove mission value, align with DoD priorities, and navigate acquisition pathways. We help teams and leaders avoid common pitfalls like compliance traps, certification dead-ends, and operational gatekeepers. Our clients get access to expert operators, contracting officers, investors, and senior DoD leaders and recieve unvarnished feedback on how well their product supports the mission, meets department priorities, and fits aquisition vehicles. Partner companies build high-confidence pathways to revenue, increase investor confidence, and accelerate momentum through the valley of death.

Texavie
Advisor
January 2024 - Present (2 years 6 months)

I advise Texavie's leadership team on product development and go-to-market strategy for its dual-use smart textile platform, NEAT SolarTex, a flexible solar fabric that converts ambient light into renewable energy.

My focus includes:
* Identifying Department of Defense and commercial applications to shape dual-use positioning

* Advising on product development priorities aligned with dual-use military operational and outdoor recreational use cases

* Defining early dual-use customer segments and developing targeted messaging across federal and outdoor markets

* Coaching the founding team on BD tactics that build government trust while preserving startup agility

This advisory role deepened my exposure to the dual-use ecosystem beyond software while reinforcing a key insight: innovative technology alone isn't enough. Without the right strategy, roadmap, resources, and execution discipline, mission-changing products may never reach the field.

Hunted Labs
Head of Product
January 2025 - June 2025 (6 months)
Seattle

Drove dual-use Entercept cybersecurity product from concept to launch, aligning product development with customer pain, market research to differentiated outcomes, and company vision to business outcomes.

As Head of Product, I:
* Led the Entercept product to general availability (GA), coordinating engineering, design, and GTM functions to a successful launch and initial customer adoption.

* Conducted deep customer discovery interviews to identify pain points and opportunities of unmet value in software supply chain security

* Defined the company's core user personas, including demographic, behavioral, and psychographic profiles, to guide feature prioritization and GTM positioning

* Ran competitive market research to isolate and emphasize differentiators in copy, roadmap, and pricing

* Completely redesigned UI and built high-fidelity prototypes to iteratively test assumptions with early users

* Wrote launch copy for the website, outbound sales campaigns, and onboarding user guides

* Established the Now / Next / Later product roadmap to connect near-term company OKRs with long-term company vision.

This work sharpened my conviction that most product failures in defense and enterprise tech come not from bad ideas, but from misalignment between product strategy, cross-functional execution, and high-velocity user outcomes.

Seeing these practices empower the successful release of Entercept necessitated the launch of our full-time consulting practice, where we now help dual-use defense tech founders and product leaders get their capability downrange in months, not years.

Rebellion Defense

3 years 2 months

GM Product Management | Iris

January 2023 - June 2024 (1 year 6 months)

Seattle, Washington, United States

Owned the product lifecycle and delivery of a $5M+ AI-enabled strategic planning portfolio for the U.S. Department of Defense, leading zero-to-one development of mission orchestration software in high-security, cloud, and disconnected environments.

Key accomplishments:

* Brought mission orchestration software from concept to revenue, generating $1M in 8 months

* Led product discovery and customer engagement to define user “Battle Manager” workflows and pain points

* Developed product vision, GTM strategy, and Now / Next / Later roadmap aligned to mission outcomes

* Built and tested a proprietary LLM to generate task interpretations, validate mission logic, and recommend adjustments—reducing tact time by 93% and improving planning throughput by 100x

* Deployed across multiple channels (cloud, on-prem, disconnected) using Docker, Kubernetes, and secure CI/CD pipelines

* Shipped advanced features including Trajectory Prediction, Pattern of Life, and Automated Target Recognition

This work exposed the most common patterns that hold back defense innovation: product/engineering misalignment, late-stage execution panic, and strategy that’s disconnected from user reality.

That experience solving these challenges has become the foundation for my consulting practice, where I now focus on helping founders lead with clarity, deploy faster, and avoid the challenges I witnessed firsthand.

Senior Technical Product Manager
May 2021 - December 2022 (1 year 8 months)
Seattle, Washington, United States

Led development and delivery of a $30M AI fusion and tracking software suite across multi-domain UAV platforms.
* Defined technical roadmap and external partner strategy to meet and exceed contract commitments

* Managed delivery of platform-agnostic SW solutions across air, land, and maritime systems

* Balanced internal R&D and customer delivery milestones to fund sustainable growth

* Led customer success efforts and transformed user feedback into roadmap insights

This role deepened my experience navigating dual-use product delivery within mission-critical environments and sharpened my perspective on aligning technical execution with strategic outcomes - Experince critical to my clients today.

Boeing
3 years 11 months

Senior Program Manager: Air Force One
November 2019 - May 2021 (1 year 7 months)
San Antonio, Texas Metropolitan Area

Led the successful transition of the Air Force One program from design in Seattle to build, test, and delivery in San Antonio. Responsible for coordinating cross-functional teams, classified infrastructure, and a 1,000-person workforce in one of the most visible defense programs in the world.

Key initiatives and outcomes:
* Served as a key liaison between Boeing leadership and U.S. Government stakeholders to ensure consistent progress, transparency, and mission assurance

* Designed and executed a $1.7M hiring and retention incentive strategy, enabling the relocation and onboarding of 300+ skilled employees with zero schedule slippage

* Managed $32M in facility upgrades to meet engineering, manufacturing, and security requirements—including SCIF compliance and sensitive material handling

* Oversaw Top Secret clearance process for 600+ employees, reducing average processing time by up to 69% through operational redesign and close collaboration with federal agencies

* Created an integrated program playbook to align union and non-represented workforce operations across engineering, HR, supply chain, and manufacturing

* Integrated complex contract requirements and aligned operations with FAR/DFARS to ensure compliance across acquisition, hiring, and security processes

This experience sharpened my ability to lead high-risk, complex programs where national security, technical delivery, and human systems all intersect. It also reinforced a truth I carry into my practice: operational clarity and leadership discipline are just as important as innovation when delivering federal defense capability.

Commercial Strategy Propulsion & Structures Portfolio Leader
July 2017 - November 2019 (2 years 5 months)
Seattle

Owned a $1.2B global aftermarket P&L for Boeing’s Propulsion and Structures product portfolio, driving double-digit revenue and margin growth through strategic pricing, market development, and supply chain innovation.

Key achievements:

* Developed growth strategy and monetization roadmap for 50-person cross-functional team, driving $199M (+22%) revenue and $101M (+16%) earnings YoY

* Closed $285M in direct engine product sales by equipping frontline teams with data-informed GTM positioning narratives

* Spearheaded and negotiated a $250M exclusive distribution agreement, increasing margin by $69M and revenue by 9x for controls and switches category segment

* Launched a $9M internal R&D initiative to vertically integrate aftermarket supply, unlocking $115M in revenue

* Delivered executive-level pricing and bundling strategies based on competitive benchmarking and customer segmentation, resulting in record YoY growth

This role honed my ability to align market insight, internal operations, and strategic storytelling into real commercial results. I now bring these skills to founders navigating GTM uncertainty and delivery challenges in dual-use markets.

Boeing
8 years 9 months

Commercial Strategy | Systems Product Line Manager
April 2015 - May 2017 (2 years 2 months)

Owned a $500M aftermarket systems parts portfolio, leading strategy, pricing, and cross-functional initiatives to grow revenue and capture value.
* Led team of business and strategy analysts to uncover insights using regression, trend analysis, and predictive modeling

* Defined portfolio strategy and investment priorities to capitalize on emerging customer and fleet trends

* Program managed cross-functional initiatives that reduced COGS, improved availability, and unlocked untapped margin

* Balanced cost, lead time, and customer value to shape roadmap decisions and competitive positioning

This role honed my ability to manage complex P&Ls, lead analytical teams, and drive execution. I now bring these skills to my clients, building dual-use businesses with mission and margin in mind.

Lead Product Manager | Passenger Seating Systems
June 2011 - April 2015 (3 years 11 months)

Led engineering design, certification, and delivery for 787 Business and Economy Class seat systems—integrating design, production, and installation schedules to support global airline customers and critical program milestones.

Key contributions:

* Defined and enforced FAA and Boeing compliance standards for third-party seat suppliers, enhancing regulatory performance and consistency

* Managed a team of 12 engineers across design, risk, certification, and airplane-level integration for multiple seat programs

* Owned end-to-end delivery of complex, SWAP-constrained seat systems—including structural hardware and in-cabin software integrations

* Developed technical data review best practices adopted across multiple suppliers, improving drawing quality and reducing design cycle time by 40%

* Delivered hardware for Business and Economy Class programs with 100% on-time delivery and no rework penalties

* Integrated supplier readiness reviews, shipping schedules, and airplane build timelines to ensure seamless final delivery

This role embedded a deep respect for design quality, stakeholder coordination, and systems thinking under constraints. These core principles now underpin my execution frameworks for my clients.

Lead Fight Test Valuestream Product Manager
September 2008 - June 2011 (2 years 10 months)

Led resolution of design and installation conflicts on the 787 flight test program’s critical path, managing cross-functional responses to test failures, certification blockers, and urgent operational disruptions. Known for turning complexity into action under pressure.

Key accomplishments:
* Orchestrated recovery effort for 787 AOG (Airplane on Ground) emergency in Laredo, TX to lead on-site planning, structural repair, and logistics coordination across Engineering, Manufacturing, and Supply Chain teams

* Developed and implemented Boeing's "Return to Flight Test Readiness" integrated plan to align engineering, tooling, planning, and part delivery schedules to reduce ground time and restore test operations

* Served as the Valuestream Product Manager for Flight Test installation, resolving interface issues between test equipment, aircraft systems, and evolving certification requirements

* Communicated critical path updates and mitigation strategies directly to Boeing executive leadership, enhancing transparency and decision velocity across functions

This experience forged my bias toward decisive communication, systems for clarity, and mission-aligned execution. These values remain central to my approach today.

Washington State Department of Transportation
Civil Engineer
July 2006 - September 2007 (1 year 3 months)

US Forest Service
Hydrologist Technician
July 2005 - September 2006 (1 year 3 months)

Education

University of Washington
Bachelor of Science (BS), Mechanical Engineering · (2004 - 2008)

Indiana University - Kelley School of Business
Master of Business Administration - MBA, Business Administration and Management, General · (2017 - 2019)

Indiana University - Kelley School of Business
Master of Science - MS, Business Analytics · (2017 - 2019)

Stevens Institute of Technology

Masters Certificate, Project Management · (2011 - 2012)